

USA: State flags

The date when each state joined the Union is shown below the state name.



SOUTH CAROLINA

1788

The flag was adopted in 1861 at the very start of the Civil War, but contains emblems used during the War of Independence and also used in the state arms. The central palmetto is the state tree.



TENNESSEE

1796

The three stars are for the three geographical divisions of the state, whilst its general appearance recalls the Battle Flag or Southern Cross. The flag was adopted in 1905.



UTAH

1896

The beehive in the flag recalls the emblem of the Mormon state of Deseret, located in Utah and the date recalls their settlement of the region. The present flag dates from 1911, and uses the seal adopted in 1896.



VIRGINIA

1788

The state arms was adopted in 1776. The seal, showing Liberty Triumphant over Tyranny, was placed on the flag in 1861 at the start of the Civil War. The design has been used ever since.



SOUTH DAKOTA

1889

The flag of South Dakota was adopted in 1963 on the basis of previous models and had the former motto "The Sunshine State" around the seal. This was changed to "The Mount Rushmore State" in 1992.



TEXAS

1845

The flag copies the colors of the Stars and Stripes, but with only one star, which dates back to one on the plain blue flag of the Republic of Texas. It was adopted in 1839 and retained after Texas joined the Union.



VERMONT

1791

The arms, including the Lone Pine emblem, date back to when Vermont was independent from 1777–91. The present flag, based on the former militia flag, was adopted in 1923. The state name appears on a scroll.



WASHINGTON

1889

Washington is known as "The Evergreen State" and this is reflected by its flag. It is the only state with a green flag. The seal dates from 1889 and was placed on the flag in 1923.